

SUNDAY

**GOD LOVES
DIVERSITY!**

**MEMORY
VERSE**

**Lord, You have made many things. With Your
wisdom You made them all. Psalm 104:24 ICB**

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INTRODUCTION

THE BLESSING OF DIVERSITY

From the time our world was created by God, we can see that God treasures diversity. He made many more stars, flowers, fruits, fish, animals, grasses, and rocks than we need to survive! The range of different creations, colors, flavors, aromas, shapes, sounds and textures that God created are amazing, and they fill us with wonder and praise and gratitude! God's love of diversity, shown by His extravagant creativity, helps us to understand how much God values our differences. He also created

humans with DNA that splits and reconnects to form a unique embryo, with an infinite number of variations.

When we understand how much God values diversity in everything He has made, we can share His love of diversity. When we grow in love, our differences can bring us closer together, to listen, to understand each other, to value each other's talents, strengths, and gifts, and to support each other through the various challenges in our lives. When we love and respect diversity, then we truly learn how to love others as Jesus loves us.

God's love of diversity, shown by His extravagant creativity.

GOD LOVES DIVERSITY!

God was busy being creative! He enjoyed designing beautiful things and arranging them in beautiful places.

He had just made a new planet, pure blue skies, and a sparkling ocean! Everything was perfect, but empty. Now He was making the flowers. He designed the petals and the leaves, decided how long the stems should be, and worked out the best way for them to make seeds. He smiled as He sprinkled tiny daisies on the grass, shaped bright sunflowers, colored the roses and created exquisite fragrances. He sculpted cacti. He grew gardens of tasty vegetables with different shapes and sizes and colors! Orange carrots, dark green spinach, tasty onions, bright tomatoes, long juicy cucumbers, and purple eggplants. Mmm, delicious!

Read together
the Creation
story: Genesis 1

He filled the world with colors and interesting designs so that we would live in a beautiful place. He created all

kinds of wonderful fruits, vegetables and grains with delicious tastes and textures so that each person could enjoy their favorite things to eat. He made the sky, with different clouds, and its beautiful colors, to welcome us in the morning and to fill us with wonder in the evening. He filled the air with all kinds of birds, and gave each one of them a different song, so that the world would be filled with their joyful singing. He filled the oceans with beautiful fish and shells and corals, just because He enjoyed making so many different things!

Then God created all kinds of animals. Tall creatures, short creatures, prickly

creatures, furry creatures, slow creatures, and fast creatures. They had different eyes, noses, ears, tails, skins, legs, and feet. They made different places to live, and they ate different foods. Each one of them was completely perfect. As He made each creation, it needed to work with everything else He had made, so that each plant had a special place to grow, and each animal could find everything it needed to eat. Wow! That's so much to think about! But God had a big and wonderful plan, and everything fitted together perfectly.

Finally, God created human beings. Man and Woman. Adam and Eve. He only made

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two people, and they were made in His image. They both looked like God because they were His beloved children. God created a special way for them to have babies, so that the world would be filled with all kinds of different people! Each person would be made in God's image so that they would show other people something about God. Each person would look different so that we would recognize each other. Each person would have different skills so that they could help each other. Each person would have different interests and ideas, so that they could learn from each other. And each person would be different so that, as they lived together and loved each other, they would learn about God's kind, loving, patient, peaceful and generous character.

GOD LOVES DIVERSITY!

“Each person would be different so that, as they lived together and loved each other, they would learn about God's kind, loving, patient, peaceful and generous character.”

MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

- Write out the memory verse using different colors and/or styles of letters.
- Or cut a variety of printed letters and glue them onto a sheet of paper to spell the verse.

PRAYER ACTIVITIES

WE'RE ALL SPECIAL!

- Thank God for something unique about each family member.
- Thank God for the ways your differences bless each other.

THANK YOU, GOD!

- Use a dice and a bag of letters.
- Throw the dice and pick a letter.
- If you throw 1 and choose A, thank God for an animal beginning with A, such as Anteater, aardvark, antelope, or ape.
- Use this guide for each side of the dice:
 1. animal
 2. bird
 3. flower/tree
 4. fruit/vegetable
 5. water feature
 6. land feature

FAMILY ACTIVITIES

DELICIOUS DIVERSITY!

- Have each person in the family choose a few favorite fruits or vegetables and make a fruit salad, or salad with them. Enjoy all the different flavors, textures, and colors.

LET'S CREATE!

- Gather any craft materials, or natural materials you can find around you.
- Work together, or on your own, to make a flower, animal, or bird out of what you can find. It doesn't have to look like a real one – design a brand-new creature!
- Once you have made it, think about where it will grow or live, and what it will eat, or sound like, etc.
- Talk about what it was like for God to create so many different things! What did He enjoy? What did He have to think about as He made them?

WONDERFULLY MADE!

- We are all wonderfully made!
- Draw pictures of yourselves on separate pieces of paper.
- Around each picture write some of the things that are special and unique about each person.
- Talk about how your differences help your family to be happy, loving, and strong.
- How does each person help the others to understand something about God's love.

PRAISE POSTER

- Draw, or cut from magazines, lots of things that God made! Trees, flowers, fruits, vegetables, animals, insects, birds, and fish, etc! Stick them on a poster.
- Praise God for His creativity at designing so many beautiful colors, shapes, textures, flavors and sounds!

CREATION EXPLORERS

- Explore a small section of your yard, garden, park, beach, or other outdoor place.
- Count how many different natural things you can find in that area.

SUNDAY SNAPSHOT!

THE VERSE

Lord, You have made many things. With Your wisdom You made them all.
Psalm 104:24 ICB

THE INTRODUCTION

When we understand how much God values diversity in everything He has made, we can share His love of diversity.

THE DEVOTIONAL

Each person would be made in God's image so that they would show other people something about God. Each person would look different so that we would recognize each other.

THE PRAYER

Thank God for something unique about each family member.

THE CONVERSATION

What are the differences between each member of your family? How do they help your family be happy, loving, and strong?